In the next section, we'll look at another conversational pattern in which AutoGen supports group chat.

4.3 Group chat with agents and AutoGen

One problem with chat delegation and nested chats or conversations is the conveyance of information. If you've ever played the telephone game, you've witnessed this firsthand and experienced how quickly information can change over iterations. With agents, this is certainly no different, and chatting through nested or sequential conversations can alter the task or even the desired result.

THE TELEPHONE GAME

The telephone game is a fun but educational game that demonstrates information and coherence loss. Children form a line, and the first child receives a message only they can hear. Then, in turn, the children verbally pass the message on to the next child, and so on. At the end, the last child announces the message to the whole group, which often isn't even close to the same message.

To counter this, AutoGen provides a group chat, a mechanism by which agents participate in a shared conversation. This allows agents to review all past conversations and better collaborate on long-running and complex tasks.

Figure 4.9 shows the difference between nested and collaborative group chats. We used the nested chat feature in the previous section to build a nested agent chat. In this section, we use the group chat to provide a more collaborative experience.